ban, the arhtiyas of Azadpur mandi, in Delhi, have been caught between a rock and a hard place.

- 'The farmer needs cash for his daily requirements. Therefore, most of our transactions were cash-based. Today, the distributor, already reeling under a demand crunch, does not have enough new notes and the farmer is not ready to accept old notes,' said Mukesh Tyagi, an arhtiya, who deals with cauliflower farmers and buyers. '*All our money is legal and all of it is accounted for. We are feeling the pinch only because we work in a cash-intensive market*,' he said.[18]

Sellers of Eggs, Poultry, Fish and Meat

When cash is short, people cut back on fruits and vegetables and stick to staples like lentils and rice. Being perishables, the prices of fruits and vegetables drop precipitously, as seen above.

The effect is even more pronounced on so-called 'luxury, non-vegetarian' foods – eggs, poultry, fish and meat. Since most of these products are sold either live or unprocessed in India, they have a very short shelf life. The market for these products also crashed after the note ban, severely affecting the livelihoods of all those engaged in their supply chains.

- 'December to January is peak season for egg sales. We sell over 15,000 eggs each day and prices are high. But, since markets are facing shortage of currency notes post-demonetization, our trade has encountered a rough patch. We could not sell even 8,000 eggs in one day and prices are falling with every passing day,' said Abdul Aziz, a wholesale egg seller in Aurangabad. 'Winter is generally a time when sales go up by around 100 per cent owing to the healthy nature of the product. However, this time people are spending less on items like eggs, and hotels have decreased their demand too.'[19]